Bow Valley College

Course Outline

HCAD1406

Meeting Complex Care Needs
Fall 2026 - Current

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Bow Valley College is situated in Treaty 7 territory. We honour the territories and Peoples of: the Blackfoot Confederacy, which includes the Siksika, Kainai, Piikani, and Amskapi Piikani (Blackfeet) First Nations; the Tsuut'ina First Nation; and the Îyâxe Nakoda, which includes the Goodstoney, Chiniki, and Bearspaw First Nations. We also acknowledge the historical Northwest Métis homeland and the Otipemisiwak Métis Government of Alberta, districts 4, 5, and 6 in Battle River territory.

HCAD1406 Meeting Complex Care Needs

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course builds on the foundational skills and concepts introduced in previous courses and also introduces new skills to the learner. Learners will have the opportunity to acquire the knowledge to learn advanced skills such as active and passive range-of-motion exercises, wound care, tube feeds, catheter care, ostomy care, specimen collection, and respiratory care. In addition, accurate measurement of vital signs is demonstrated, practised, and assessed. This course will also assist learners to work safely within the legal roles and responsibilities of health care aides in this province while providing medication assistance. This course is included in the HCA Preparation for Employment provincial standard. Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

REQUISITES	Earn a minimum grade of B- in each of the following courses: • HCAD1401 - Health Care Aide Role & Responsibility (3) • HCAD1402 - The Human Body, Health & Chronic Illness (3) • HCAD1403 - Communication & Documentation in the Health Care Environment (4) • HCAD1404 - Providing Person-Centred Care & Comfort (5)
EQUIVALENTS	None
CREDITS	5
HOURS	75
ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR	Yes
ZERO TEXTBOOK COST	No

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong students. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that students acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

College-Wide Outcomes:

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills

3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy
6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning
8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

#	COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED
1	Describe knowledge of assisting with complex skills (ROM, wound care, nasogastric/gastrostomy tube feeds, urinary catheters/drainage, measuring vital signs, pain, height/weight, specimen collection, ostomies, respiratory care, oral suctioning, and medication assistance) using basic knowledge of the body systems.	1,2,7,8
2	Identify the limitations of the HCA role and responsibilities when assisting with complex skills as outlined by government legislation and employer policies and procedures.	1,2,9
3	Define evidence-informed practice and guidelines for each complex skill.	2,7,8
4	Demonstrate ethical person-centred care related to assisting with each complex skill and following the client care plan in the acute and continuing care settings (home care, long-term care, and supportive living).	4,6,7
5	Identify knowledge of the collaborative team's roles and responsibilities within each complex skill.	1,4,6,8
6	Describe key elements of the palliative care approach that can be applied to the planning, implementation, and delivery of complex skills.	1,2,7,8
7	Demonstrate competence (knowledge, skills, behaviours, and attitudes) by applying evidence-informed practice and guidelines when assisting with complex skills.	1,4,6,8
8	Apply the principles of professional and accurate communication through instruction, delivery, reporting, and documentation of complex skills.	3,4,5,8
9	Apply communication techniques and strategies that support diverse clients displaying responsive behaviours when assisting with the delivery of complex skills.	1,2,3,5
10	Demonstrate client and personal safety by recognizing and responding to safety hazards, near misses, reporting abuse, following infection prevention and control principles, client handling, and operating health equipment safely.	1,2,4,6,8,9,10

COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

WEEK/HOURS	MODULES
Week 1	Module 1: Range of Motion/Module 2: Assisting with Wound Care
Week 2	Module 3: Assisting with Nasogastric and Gastrostomy Care and Tube Feeds/Module 4: Assisting with Urinary Catheter and Drainage Systems
Week 3	Module 5: Assisting with Ostomy Care/Module 6: Measuring Vital Signs, Pain, Height, and Weight
Week 4	Module 6: Measuring Vital Signs, Pain, Height, and Weight
Week 5	Module 7: Assisting with Specimen Collection/Module 8: Assisting with Respiratory Care and Oral Suctioning
Week 6	Module 9: Medication Assistance
Week 7	Reading Week (dates may vary)
Week 8	Module 9: Medication Assistance
Week 9	Consolidation Lab
Week 10	Consolidation Lab/Final Exam

ASSESSMENT

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	ASSESSMENT	WEIGHT
1-10	Final Exam	100%
1-10	Completion of Lab Skills	Pass/Fail

Important: For details on each assignment and exam, please see the Course Offering Information.

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A minimum grade of D is required to pass this course. However, a program may require a higher grade in this course to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

As per the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum and Licensing Policies, learners are required to achieve a minimum grade of B- (70%) to pass all theory and lab courses, including this

course. As well, in courses HCAD1401, HCAD1403, HCAD1404, HCAD1406, and HCAD1407 learners must achieve a "pass" on all lab skills outlined in the Lab Skills Guide.

Please consult with the program area or contact the program chair for further details. A minimum Grade Point Average of 2.0 is required for graduation.

GRADING SCHEME

Grade	Percentage	Grade Point	Description
A+	95-100	4.0	Exceptional: superior knowledge of subject matter
A	90-94	4.0	Excellent: outstanding knowledge of subject matter
A-	85-89	3.67	
B+	80-84	3.33	
B	75-79	3.0	Very Good: knowledge of subject matter generally mastered
B-	70-74	2.67	
C+	67-69	2.33	
C	64-66	2.0	Satisfactory/Acceptable: knowledge of subject matter adequately mastered
C-	60-63	1.67	
D+	57-59	1.33	
D	50-56	1.0	Minimal Pass
F	Less than 50	0.0	Fail: an unsatisfactory performance

REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

Government of Alberta. *(2019). Health care aide provincial curriculum learner guide: Course 6 meeting complex care needs*. Edmonton, AB.

(A digital copy is available in Brightspace, or a printed copy can be purchased at the bookstore.)

Government of Alberta. (2019). *Health care aide provincial curriculum lab skills guide courses 1, 3, 4, 6 and 7*. Edmonton, AB.

(A digital copy is available in Brightspace, or a printed copy can be purchased at the bookstore.)

Sorrentino, S., Remmert, L., Wilk, M., Newmaster, R. (2021). Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker– Text, Workbook and Clinical Skills: Skills for Nurse Assisting. (5th Canadian ed.) Toronto: Elsevier Canada or current edition. (ISBN: 9780323880626)

OR

Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker Elsevier eBook on VitalSource, 5th Cdn. (Purchase on the Evolve site. The ISBN is: 9780323711661)

Canadian Clinical Skills: Skills for Personal Support Workers, 1st Cdn Edition by Elsevier

HCA Lab Kit (Available for purchase at the bookstore)

Bow Valley College Health Care Aide Program Scrub Uniform (Grey/Black) (Available for purchase at the Bookstore)

Latex-free gloves (100 gloves).

Government of Alberta. (2019). Health care aide provincial curriculum lab skills guide courses 1, 3, 4, 6 and 7 . Edmonton, AB.

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

Additional Resources:

AHCA/NACL. (2013, December 5). *Range of motion exercises: CNA and patient*. [Video]. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WZjoqkO0xzw

Alberta Government. (2021). *Learning about how to care for a person's indwelling urinary catheter*. Health information and tools. Retrieved November 24, 2021, from

https://myhealth.alberta.ca/Health/aftercareinformation/pages/conditions.aspx?hwid=abs2318

Alberta Government. (2021). *Insulin pump therapy learning module*. Retrieved November 24, 2021, from https://myhealth.alberta.ca/learning/modules/insulin-pump-therapy

Alberta Health Services. (2022, April 8). *Medication Assistance Program Manual (MAP)*. Retrieved April 28, 2022 from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/assets/info/seniors/if-sen-map-program-in-alberta.pdf

Alberta Health Services. (2018, August 30). *Virtual reality for wound care patients a Canadian first*. Retrieved November 24, 2021 from https://albertahealthservices.ca/news/Page14623.aspx

Alberta Health Services. (2020, November). *Eating well after ostomy surgery*. Retrieved November 24, 2021, from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/assets/info/nutrition/if-nfs-eating-well-after-ileostomy-surgery.pdf

CLWK Connecting Learners with Knowledge. (2021). *Skin & Wound Community of Practice*. Retrieved November 23, 2021, from https://www.clwk.ca/communities-of-practice/skin-wound-community-of-practice/

CLWK Connecting Learners with Knowledge. (2021). *Skin and Wound Community of Practice eLearning Modules: Skin & Wound Care*. Retrieved November 24, 2021, from https://www.clwk.ca/communities-of-practice/skin-wound-community-of-practice/eLearning_Module/

College of Registered Nurses of Alberta, College of Licensed Practical Nurses of Alberta, & College of Registered Psychiatric Nurses of Alberta. (2010). *Decision making standards for nurses in the supervision of health care aides: Restricted activities and activities of daily living*.

[Joint document on the websites of the three organizations]. Retrieved November 24, 2021, from https://www.clpna.com/wp-content/uploads/2013/02/doc_Decision-Making_Standards_in_Supervision_of_Health_Care_Aides_2010.pdf

Government of Alberta. (2013). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 5 Module 1 Meeting complex care needs*. Edmonton, AB

Government of Alberta. (2018). *Alberta health care aide competency profil*e. Retrieved November 23, 2021, from https://open.alberta.ca/dataset/e1fbd562-1571-40b8-bc17-71687dab444c/resource/9e34d246-c389-4753-bda4-f53a77e02f80/download/ah-hca-core-competency-profile-2018.pdf

Hollister. (2021, October 23). *The 3 types of ostomies*. Ostomy Learning Center. Retrieved November 24, 2021, from https://www.hollister.com/en/OstomyCare/OstomyLearningCenter/UnderstandingAnOstomy/The3TypesOfOstomies

National Pressure Ulcer Advisory Panel. (2016). *Pressure ulcer stages*. Retrieved November 23, 2021, from https://npiap.com/page/PressureInjuryStages

Perry, G. A., & Potter, P. (2014). *Canadian Fundamentals of Nursing* (5th ed.). Toronto, ON: Elsevier Canada.

Potter, P. A., Perry, A.G., Stockert, P.A., & Hall, A.M. (Eds.). (2014). *Canadian fundamentals of nursing* (5th Cdn. ed.) (J. C. Ross-Kerr, M. J. Wood, B. J. Astle & W. Duggleby, Cdn. Adapt.). Toronto, ON: Elsevier Canada.

Wilk, M. (2022). Applying a dry, nonsterile dressing. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Assisting with pressure injury prevention and care. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Assisting with Range-of-motion exercises. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Giving Catheter Care. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Removing and Applying a Condom Catheter. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Changing an Ostomy Pouch. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Taking a Radial Pulse. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Taking an Apical Pulse. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Counting Respirations. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Taking a Temperature with an Electronic Thermometer. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Measuring Blood Pressure. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Using a Pulse Oximeter. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Collecting a Midstream Specimen. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Collecting a 24-hr Urine Specimen. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Collecting a Stool Specimen. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Collecting a Sputum Specimen. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Assisting with Deep Breathing and Coughing Exercises. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Wilk, M. (2022). Measuring Blood Glucose. *Sorrentino's Canadian clinical skills: Skills for personal support workers*. https://evolve.elsevier.com

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Students with documented disabilities (e.g., mental health diagnosis, learning disability, physical disability, etc.) may qualify for classroom and/or exam accommodations. The College can also assist students who may be experiencing difficulties with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. Students who need academic and exam accommodations based on other protected grounds may also make those

requests.
It is the student's responsibility to request academic accommodations. Students are encouraged to contact Accessibility Services as early as possible.

Visit: Learner Success Services- 1st floor south campus
Contact: accessibility@bowvalleycollege.ca or 403-410-1440
BVC Central: Accessibility Services

INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Integrity (500-1-7), Student Code of Conduct (500-1-1), Student Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1- 10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13).
Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by students is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan. Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

Academic Integrity:

At Bow Valley College, we value academic integrity. This means everyone at the college, including students, faculty, and staff, follow principles that foster ethical and truthful ways of being in their work and studies. The college is committed to integrity being infused in all aspects of work and studies. It is important to act with integrity in everything you do at the college. The values you practice at the college are the same values that will inform and guide your career. If someone breaks from the principles that are in agreement with academic integrity policy, the college is committed to carefully investigating and fairly handling any issues related to academic integrity and academic misconduct.

Academic misconduct is acting in such a way as to give yourself or others an unfair academic advantage or disadvantage. Examples of this can include:

- Plagiarism
- Cheating on tests or exams
- Tampering with or falsifying any grades or documents
- Sharing assignments or exam information with others
- Aiding others in dishonest acts
- Using artificial intelligence in graded work without the explicit consent of the instructor
- Recording anything in the classroom or other instructional area without permission

Breaking from the principles that guide academic integrity can lead to educative interventions and/or punitive measures. It is the student's responsibility to review the Academic Integrity Policy. Please review the following resources:

- Academic Integrity Policy Summary
- Academic Integrity Policy
- Academic Integrity Procedure

Turnitin:

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student work. Students acknowledge that any course work or essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

Online Exam Proctoring:

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where either the course instructor, a representative of Bow Valley College, or a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, https://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/academic-calendar.
Students are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

Collection of Personal Information:

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements. You may use the recordings only for educational purposes. You must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission. Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 4 (c) of the Protection of Privacy Act, Alberta (POPA) to deliver academic programming, support student flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course

activities and outcomes. Bow Valley College uses automated systems to generate content and make decisions, recommendations and predictions, and your personal information may be included in these automated systems.

Your personal information will be used and disclosed in accordance with sections 12 and 13 of POPA and protected in accordance with section 10 of POPA. If you have any questions about the collection, use, disclosure or protection of personal information, please contact the Access and Privacy Officer at privacy@bowvalleycollege.ca.